

Transforming Lives Through Nutrition: Rejoice's Inspiring Journey

Meet Joseph Rejoice, a vibrant young child from Onicha local government area in Ebonyi. Rejoice's path to health and well-being was significantly impacted by an extraordinary initiative organized by Life Helpers Initiative (LHI) in partnership with the IHP Nutrition project.

Upon her arrival at the Onicha health facility, Rejoice was assessed to be severely malnourished. Her anthropometric measurements revealed an **MUAC of just 11.2 cm, a weight of 8.6 kg, a height of 70 cm, and an age of 16 months**. It was evident that her health was in a precarious state, and her mother voiced concerns about her feeding challenges, primarily due to financial constraints.

Rejoice's mother received personalized guidance on nutrition, with a focus on creating five-star meals using locally available and affordable foods. She was encouraged to introduce fortified pap, nourishing potato porridge, and incorporate essential animal sources, fruits, and vegetables into Rejoice's diet. The importance of a diet rich in vegetables, fruits, and animal sources, including cooked eggs, was emphasized. Additionally, the concept of a home garden was

introduced, offering faster access to nutritious vegetables.

Rejoice's journey to recovery didn't stop there. She was referred to an IMAM Center, where she received crucial support. Furthermore, Rejoice was provided with Tom Brown and beans from the Food Bank,



1st Visit

2nd Visit

3rd Visit

ensuring a consistent supply of nutritious essentials. The commitment of Rejoice's mother was commendable as she actively participated in food demonstration sessions, absorbing valuable knowledge for her child's well-being.

The transformation was nothing short of remarkable. During the third visit, everyone presents, including the mother, health workers, and fellow caregivers, witnessed the astonishing progress in Rejoice's health. She had transitioned from Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM) to Moderate Acute Malnutrition (MAM), as evidenced by her improved MUAC of 12.4 cm, weight of 8.8 kg, height of 76 cm, and 17 months old.

Rejoice's journey stands as a testament to the power of education, compassion, and dedicated intervention. Her remarkable turnaround from a state of severe malnutrition to one of steady progress and hope showcases the profound impact of initiatives like LHI's and the IHP Nutrition project. Rejoice's story is not just one of transformation; it's a story of resilience, empowerment, and the boundless possibilities that can emerge when communities come together to support the health and well-being of their youngest members.

